

Local topological order parameters in dimerized spin systems via quantum algorithms

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The present work is a summary of my personal research notes of the I concepts needed and learned during my AScI internship at Aalto University. I have set them up in a way which would have aided my past-self in swiftly learning the topics. I have added personal interpretations, comparisons, and figures to give myself, and hopefully any other reader, a better understanding.

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I. INTRODUCTION

The Heisenberg model describes magnetic interactions between spins fixed on a lattice. This model provides information on how macroscopic properties like magnetism emerge from quantum interactions. On the other hand, quantum computing leverages quantum mechanics to perform calculations, making it an adequate platform to simulate and analyze quantum matter. The present work focuses on calculating quantized Berry phases on a spin chain, which serve as a local topological order parameter, with the aid of a quantum algorithm. Intuitively, the aim is to characterize different states of a spin chain.

II. BERRY PHASE & TOPOLOGY

The following notes are taken & mixed from Solemn & Biedenharn¹ and Xiao et al².

The Berry phase is a "consequence of the unobservable nature of the phase space"¹. It is also called the geometrical phase, as it depends on the "geometry" of the parameters that a Hamiltonian depends on. We will consider a Hamiltonian H which depends on parameters $\mathbf{q} = (q_1, q_2, \dots)$. The Hamiltonian is slowly varied on a closed circuit in parameter space, from an initial time to a final time, such that $\mathbf{q}(0) = \mathbf{q}(T)$. The evolution of a vector is determined by the time-dependent Schrödinger equation:

$$H(\mathbf{q}(t))|\psi(t)\rangle = i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi(t)\rangle. \quad (1)$$

At any time, there exists a basis set of eigenstates that are labeled by n at time t , such that they fulfill the time-independent Schrödinger equation:

$$H(\mathbf{q}(t))|\psi_n(\mathbf{q}(t))\rangle = E_n(\mathbf{q}(t))|\psi_n(\mathbf{q}(t))\rangle. \quad (2)$$

A typical result of adiabatic (slow) evolution, is that a system that starts in the n -th eigenvector will evolve adiabatically (slowly) with H , such that it stays labeled by n , and acquires a dynamical phase³:

$$|\psi(t)\rangle = \exp\left[\frac{-i}{\hbar} \int_0^t E_n(\mathbf{q}(t')) dt'\right] |\psi_n(\mathbf{q}(t))\rangle. \quad (3)$$

However, Equation 2 alone does not uniquely determine the statevector, as one can arbitrarily choose a phase that depends on the parameters (and time). Taking this into account, Equation 3 can be adjusted such that the evolution of a state takes into account the arbitrary phase:

$$|\psi(t)\rangle = \exp\left[\frac{-i}{\hbar} \int_0^t E_n(\mathbf{q}(t')) dt'\right] \exp(i\gamma_n(t)) |\psi_n(\mathbf{q}(t))\rangle. \quad (4)$$

The first exponent of Equation 4 is called the dynamical phase, and the second exponent is called the geometrical (Berry) phase, we can rewrite as:

$$|\psi(t)\rangle = e^{i\theta_n(t)} e^{i\gamma_n(t)} |\psi_n(\mathbf{q}(t))\rangle. \quad (5)$$

where $\theta_n(t) = \frac{-1}{\hbar} \int_0^t E_n(\mathbf{q}(t')) dt'$. Let us understand some properties of the geometrical phase by inserting Equation 5 into Equation 1:

$$H|\psi(t)\rangle = i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \left(e^{i\theta_n(t)} e^{i\gamma_n(t)} |\psi_n\rangle \right) \quad (6)$$

Let's work first on the right-hand side by expanding the time derivative:

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \left(e^{i\theta_n(t)} e^{i\gamma_n(t)} \right) |\psi_n\rangle + e^{i\theta_n(t)} e^{i\gamma_n(t)} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi_n\rangle \\ &= \left(e^{i\gamma_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{i\theta_n} + e^{i\theta_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{i\gamma_n} + e^{i\gamma_n} e^{i\theta_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \right) |\psi_n\rangle \end{aligned} \quad (7)$$

Let's work on some individual parts, starting with the derivative of the dynamical phase:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{i\theta_n} = e^{i\theta_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} i\theta_n \quad (8)$$

$$= e^{i\theta_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \frac{-i}{\hbar} \int_0^t E_n(\mathbf{q}(t')) dt' = \frac{-i}{\hbar} e^{i\theta_n} E_n(\mathbf{q}(t)).$$

Now the derivative of the geometrical phase:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{i\gamma_n} = i e^{i\gamma_n} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n. \quad (9)$$

Lastly the derivative of the eigenvector (using the chain rule):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi_n\rangle &= \frac{\partial |\psi_n\rangle}{\partial q_1} \frac{\partial q_1}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial |\psi_n\rangle}{\partial q_2} \frac{\partial q_2}{\partial t} + \dots \\ &= \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} |\psi_n\rangle \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t}. \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

Inserting the parts into Equation 7:

$$e^{i\gamma_n} e^{i\theta_n} \left(\frac{-i}{\hbar} E_n + i \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \right) |\psi_n\rangle. \quad (11)$$

Returning to Equation 6, we put in the reduced right-hand side Equation 11:

$$H|\psi(t)\rangle = e^{i\gamma_n} e^{i\theta_n} \left(E_n - \hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + i\hbar \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \right) |\psi_n\rangle. \quad (12)$$

$$\left(e^{i\theta_n} e^{i\gamma_n} \right) H|\psi_n(t)\rangle = e^{i\gamma_n} e^{i\theta_n} \left(E_n - \hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + i\hbar \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \right) |\psi_n\rangle.$$

$$H|\psi_n(t)\rangle = \left(E_n - \hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + i\hbar \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \right) |\psi_n\rangle.$$

Dotting with the same eigenstate:

$$\langle \psi_n | H | \psi_n \rangle = \langle \psi_n | \left(E_n - \hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + i\hbar \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \right) | \psi_n \rangle. \quad (13)$$

$$E_n = E_n - \hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n + i\hbar \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \cdot \langle \psi_n | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi_n \rangle \quad (14)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \gamma_n = i \langle \psi_n | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi_n \rangle \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \quad (15)$$

We arrive at the conclusion that the Berry phase fulfilling Equation 15 is a valid solution to Schrödinger's equation. This means that during adiabatic evolution, a system will gain in addition to the normal dynamical phase, a geometrical phase.

A. Berry vector potential & gauge dependence

We define the Berry vector potential (often called the Berry connection) as:

$$\mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}) = i \langle \psi_n | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi_n \rangle. \quad (16)$$

Thus the Berry phase can be obtained as an integral dependent only on the path of the parameters during adiabatic evolution:

$$\frac{d}{dt} \gamma_n(t) = \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}) \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} \quad (17)$$

$$\gamma_n(t) = \int_0^t \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}(t)) \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{q}}{\partial t} dt$$

$$\gamma_n = \int_C \mathbf{A}_n \cdot d\mathbf{q},$$

where C denotes the curve of the parameters. We can now see that the Berry phase is completely determined by the path that the parameters take, hinting at the geometric properties.

The Berry potential is gauge dependent. Taking a gauge transform using smooth functions $f(\mathbf{q})$:

$$|\psi_n\rangle \rightarrow e^{if(\mathbf{q})} |\psi_n\rangle. \quad (18)$$

the Berry potential then changes accordingly:

$$\mathbf{A}_n \rightarrow i \langle \psi_n | e^{-if} \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} e^{if} | \psi_n \rangle \quad (19)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= i \langle \psi_n | e^{-if} (e^{if} \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi_n \rangle + i e^{if} | \psi_n \rangle \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} f) \\
&= i \langle \psi_n | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi_n \rangle - \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} f(\mathbf{q}) \\
&\therefore \mathbf{A}_n \rightarrow \mathbf{A}_n - \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} f(\mathbf{q}). \tag{20}
\end{aligned}$$

The geometrical phase is then also affected by a gauge transformation:

$$\begin{aligned}
\gamma_n &\rightarrow \int_C (\mathbf{A}_n - \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} f(\mathbf{q})) \cdot d\mathbf{q} \tag{21} \\
&= \gamma_n - \int_C \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} f(\mathbf{q}) \cdot d\mathbf{q} = \gamma_n - (f(\mathbf{q}_f) - f(\mathbf{q}_0)) \\
&= \gamma_n - \Delta f
\end{aligned}$$

It was then believed that one could choose a suitable transform $f(\mathbf{q})$ that would always cancel out the geometrical phase. The gauge dependence implies that the Berry phase is not observable, which explains why for a long time it did not affect experiments. However, Michael Berry challenged this remark by considering a closed loop in parameters, i.e a cyclic evolution:

$$\mathbf{q}(0) = \mathbf{q}(T). \tag{22}$$

The gauge transform $f(\mathbf{q})$ is smooth and must map uniquely eigenstates with one set of parameters to another. It must also be single-valued in the range $[0, 2\pi)$. This means that the Berry phase in a closed loop can only be changed in multiples of 2π :

$$e^{if(\mathbf{q}(0))} | \psi_n \rangle = e^{if(\mathbf{q}(T))} | \psi_n \rangle \tag{23}$$

$$e^{i(f(\mathbf{q}(T)) - f(\mathbf{q}(0)))} | \psi_n \rangle = | \psi_n \rangle$$

$$\therefore f(\mathbf{q}(T)) - f(\mathbf{q}(0)) = 2n\pi \tag{24}$$

Thus when the Berry phase evolves in a closed path, we cannot choose a gauge that cancels out the Berry phase, only change the gauge which invariantly adds multiples of 2π . Thus, in a closed path, the Berry phase is a gauge-invariant quantity that cannot be removed, and is thus observable, and is expressed as:

$$\gamma_n = \oint_C \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}) \cdot d\mathbf{q}. \tag{25}$$

Thus, the Berry phase only depends on the geometric aspect of the closed path in parameter space, independent of time.

B. Curvature & topological notions

The Berry phase depends on how the potential changes in a closed path. More intuitively, the Berry phase depends on how Eigenstates evolve (project onto each other) in a closed path in parameter space. Inspired by the fact that the Berry phase depends on a geometrical notion of a closed path, the Berry curvature tensor is defined from the Berry vector potential:

$$\Omega_{\mu\nu}^n(\mathbf{q}) = \frac{\partial}{\partial q^\mu} A_\nu^n - \frac{\partial}{\partial q^\nu} A_\mu^n, \tag{26}$$

$$\Omega_{\mu\nu}^n(\mathbf{q}) = i [\langle \partial q^\mu \psi_n | \partial q^\nu \psi_n \rangle - \langle \partial q^\nu \psi_n | \partial q^\mu \psi_n \rangle] \tag{27}$$

where n identifies the n -th eigenstate in question, and the Greek indices are the different coordinates of the parameter space. It is important to highlight that the curvature tensor is gauge-invariant, and thus a physical observable. We have our first topological notion. We can deform the Berry potential by choosing different gauges, but the curvature will remain invariant. The Berry curvature is invariant to first-order deformations.

Using Stoke's theorem², we can get an expression for the Berry phase as an integral over a surface S enclosed by a curve C :

$$\gamma_n = \frac{1}{2} \int_S \Omega_{\mu\nu}^n(\mathbf{q}) dq^\mu \wedge dq^\nu. \tag{28}$$

Thus the Berry curvature can define the Berry phase. When the parameter space is three dimensional, the Berry curvature becomes a 3-vector:

$$\mathbf{\Omega}_n(\mathbf{q}) = \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \times \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}), \tag{29}$$

which then seems to act as a magnetic field in parameter space:

$$\gamma_n = \int_S \mathbf{\Omega}_n(\mathbf{q}) \cdot d\mathbf{S} = \int_S \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \times \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}) \cdot d\mathbf{S} \tag{30}$$

$$\gamma_n = \oint_C \mathbf{A}_n(\mathbf{q}) \cdot d\mathbf{q}.$$

A question arises: curvature of what? By analyzing the equations, one realizes that it is in a sense, the curvature of the space of Eigenstates mapped from Hamiltonians, connected by paths along parameters which serve as coordinates. The Berry vector potential is a measure of first-order change in Eigenstates when moving along the coordinates (parameters). The Berry curvature tensor is a measure of second-order change in Eigenstates. Thus, the curvature remains invariant to gauge transformations, which are first-order changes. Gauge transformations are homeomorphic maps of the Eigenstate manifold to other Eigenstate manifolds, which have the same curvature.

It is instructive to show the definition of Berry curvature via perturbation theory:

$$\Omega_{\mu\nu}^n(q) = i \sum_{n' \neq n} \frac{\langle \psi_n | \partial H / \partial q^\mu | \psi_{n'} \rangle \langle \psi_{n'} | \partial H / \partial q^\nu | \psi_n \rangle - (\mu \leftrightarrow \nu)}{(E_n - E_{n'})^2}. \quad (31)$$

We can then see that as indexed energies approach each other, the curvature explodes to infinity. This means that, if you change the Hamiltonian along a curve and it becomes degenerate, it is not simply connected to the "other side" of the singularity (through that path). The following figure might perhaps serve as intuition:

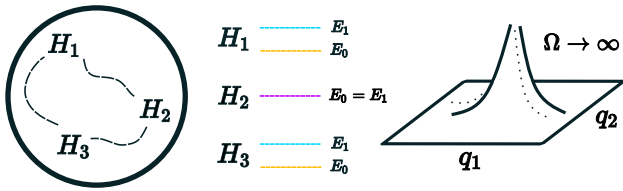


FIG. 1. Hamiltonian evolution along degenerate path, which gives rise to infinite curvature.

the space of states has paths connecting eigenstates of different Hamiltonians (via the parameters). When evolving one Hamiltonian to the other, it may happen that the eigenstates becomes degenerate. Should this be the case, you can not uniquely define a smooth map of one eigenstate to another eigenstate along that path. We can now partition our space of Hamiltonians into different classes, consisting of Hamiltonians connected by paths (parameters), whose Eigenstates can be uniquely and smoothly mapped to each other.

Remembering that our paths must form closed curves, we can visualize nicely some topological notions in the following figure.

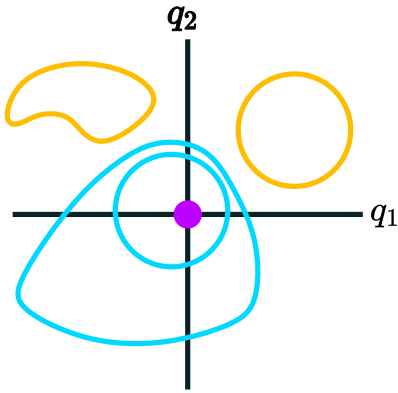


FIG. 2. Closed curves in parameter space. Middle purple dot indicates infinite curvature $\Omega = \infty$. One cannot continuously deform paths that enclose the singularity to paths that do not contain the singularity.

In Figure 2, it can be seen that if a path encloses a singularity, it cannot be smoothly mapped to a path without the singularity. Since these states do not have smooth maps to each other (due to the infinite curvature at the origin), we can partition our states to topologically distinct ones. This is our first concrete sense of topological spaces. A more intuitive understanding, is that perturbations that do not close the energy band-gap conform topologically equivalent phases, while those that collapse the band-gap are topologically inequivalent. We can characterize the different phases (inequivalent closed paths of the states) using topological properties, called topological invariants in condensed matter physics.

C. Geometric intuition

Should any reader be already familiar with relativity and curved geometry, it can be instructive to make an analogy. In relativity, one considers the curvature of space-time, defined by the Riemann curvature tensor $R_{\alpha\beta\mu\nu}$. It is defined by second derivatives of the metric tensor along space-time coordinates:

$$R_{\alpha\beta\mu\nu} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\partial x^\mu \partial x^\beta g_{\alpha\nu} - \partial x^\nu \partial x^\beta g_{\alpha\mu} + \dots \right). \quad (32)$$

It is a measure of how much a vector changes via parallel-transport in a closed loop⁴:

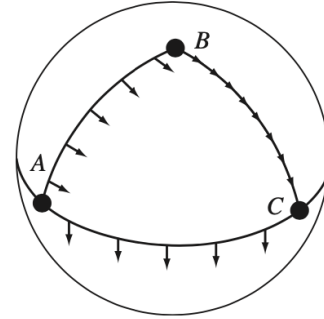


FIG. 3. Parallel transport in a closed loop on a sphere. Figure from Schutz⁴.

Just like the curvature of space-time involves second derivatives (and any other curvature object like the EM tensor), the Berry curvature involves second derivatives of eigenstates. The space of eigenstates is the field we are concerned with, whose coordinates are the parameters, and the distance between states is the inner product. The curvature measures how much our eigenstates change when evolving them in a closed loop in parameter space.

III. DIMERIZED HEISENBERG MODEL

The Heisenberg model, as stated in the introduction, describes interactions between spins on a lattice. It's most basic mathematical statement is⁵:

$$H = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{ij} J_{ij} \mathbf{S}_i \cdot \mathbf{S}_j, \quad (33)$$

where J_{ij} is the link strength, and $\mathbf{S}_i$ are the typical spin vectors whose entries are the Pauli matrices:

$$\mathbf{S} = \frac{\hbar}{2} (\sigma_x, \sigma_y, \sigma_z). \quad (34)$$

A. Dimerized spin chain

The dimerized model is a 1D spin chain of nearest neighbor interactions:

$$H = \sum_i J_i \vec{S}_i \cdot \vec{S}_{i+1} = \sum_i H_i \quad (35)$$

which has a *dimer pattern*, which we define as

$$J_i = \begin{cases} J & i = 0 \pmod{2} \\ \alpha = J/g & i = 1 \pmod{2} \end{cases} \quad (36)$$

with g acting as a modulator. If the system is finite in size, then a periodic condition is assumed. The model can be seen in Figure 4.



FIG. 4. Dimerized Heisenberg model

This model can be characterized by local topological order parameters on each link. The topological order parameter is the Berry phase as will be explained in the following subsections. One can calculate the Berry phase on each link, quantized, and takes on the same pattern as the dimer chain, being π for the strong links and 0 for the weak links.

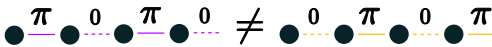


FIG. 5. Local Berry phase on links with different patterns.

B. Quantization of the Berry phase: Antiunitary symmetry

The following discussion is taken from Hatusgai's work⁶⁷ and modified with the present notation. Seeing as the Berry

phase is a gauge-invariant quantity when evolving in a closed loop, only being able to modify it in multiples of 2π (Equation 25), it has an invariant meaning up to an integer multiple:

$$\gamma_n = \oint \mathbf{A}_n \cdot d\mathbf{q}, \pmod{2\pi n}. \quad (37)$$

Let us now consider an antiunitary operator $\Phi = KU$, where K denotes complex conjugation and U is some unitary operator. We define a statevector expanded on a parameter independent basis:

$$|\psi(\mathbf{q})\rangle = \sum_j C_j(\mathbf{q}) |j\rangle. \quad (38)$$

The action of the antiunitary operator is then:

$$|\psi'(\mathbf{q})\rangle = \Phi |\psi(\mathbf{q})\rangle = \sum_j C_j^*(\mathbf{q}) |j'\rangle, \quad (39)$$

where $|j'\rangle = \Phi |j\rangle$. It is assumed that both bases $|j\rangle$ and $|j'\rangle$ form complete orthonormal bases. How is the Berry phase modified? Let us first explicitly write out the Berry connection expanded in the basis $|j\rangle$:

$$\mathbf{A} = i \langle \psi | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi \rangle \quad (40)$$

$$= i \sum_j C_j^* \langle j | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_k C_k | k \rangle$$

$$= i \sum_j \sum_k C_j^* \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} C_k \langle j | k \rangle$$

$$= i \sum_j C_j^* \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} C_j$$

Similarly, for the Berry connection on a vector being modified by the antiunitary operator:

$$\mathbf{A}' = i \langle \psi' | \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} | \psi' \rangle \quad (41)$$

$$= i \sum_j C_j \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} C_j^*.$$

Let's expand the coefficients into their amplitude and phase:

$$\mathbf{A}' = i \sum_j r_j(\mathbf{q}) e^{i\varphi_j(\mathbf{q})} \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} r_j(\mathbf{q}) e^{-i\varphi_j(\mathbf{q})} \quad (42)$$

$$= i \sum_j r_j e^{i\varphi_j} (e^{-i\varphi_j} \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} r_j(\mathbf{q}) - i r_j e^{-i\varphi_j} \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \varphi_j(\mathbf{q}))$$

$$= i \sum_j r_j (\nabla_{\mathbf{q}} r_j(\mathbf{q}) - i r_j \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \phi_j(\mathbf{q}))$$

It is important to note that the first term in parantheses must cancel out since we asumed a complete orthonormal basis $\sum_j |C_j|^2 = \sum_j r_j^2 = 1$, thus:

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \sum_j r_j^2 = \sum_j 2r_j \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} r_j = 0, \quad (43)$$

$$\therefore \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} r_j = 0. \quad (44)$$

We then arrive at the conclusion that:

$$\mathbf{A}' = \sum_j r_j^2 \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \phi_j(\mathbf{q}). \quad (45)$$

Similarly for the unmodified Berry connection:

$$\mathbf{A} = - \sum_j r_j^2 \nabla_{\mathbf{q}} \phi_j(\mathbf{q}). \quad (46)$$

Which then clearly means that the Berry connections and phases are related, after the antiunitary operation, by:

$$\mathbf{A} = -\mathbf{A}', \quad (47)$$

$$\gamma_n = -\gamma_n'. \quad (48)$$

The situation becomes more interesting if we have a Hamiltonian that is invariant under said antiunitary operation:

$$[H, \Phi] = 0, \quad (49)$$

since this means that if an eigenstate $|\psi_n\rangle$ is unique, then the antiunitary operator leaves the state the same up to some phase factor, meaning it simply changes the gauge:

$$|\psi_n'\rangle = \Phi |\psi_n\rangle = e^{f(\mathbf{q})} |\psi_n\rangle, \quad (50)$$

but we already saw that gauge changes are invariant up to multiples of 2π :

$$\gamma_n = \gamma_n' \pmod{2n\pi}. \quad (51)$$

This actually results in the quantization of the Berry phase. Only $\gamma = \{0, \pi\}$ satisfy both Equation 48 and Equation 51. It only fails if the gauge becomes singular, meaning that the Hamiltonian is degenerate.

Hatsugai⁶ shows that the quantization of the Berry phase serves as a local characterization of a quantum liquid, such as a spin chain. The Berry phase serves as a local topological order parameter, since it becomes robust against small perturbations⁷.

C. Twisting the chain

How then are we to calculate the Berry phase and characterize the dimerized spin chain? We have to evolve some parameter of the Hamiltonian in Equation 35 which does not close the energy-gap (clearly if $J = \alpha$ the gap closes, the ground state is a degenerate ferromagnet⁸). Hatsugai⁶ introduces a local twist on one link, which can be evolved in a closed loop without closing the energy gap. The adiabatic twist on the link T in the chain can be defined as:

$$H_T \rightarrow J_T \left(\frac{e^{-i\theta}}{2} S_T^+ S_{T+1}^- + \frac{e^{+i\theta}}{2} S_T^- S_{T+1}^+ + Z_T Z_{T+1} \right), \quad (52)$$

with the ladder operators

$$S_T^+ = X_T + iY_T \quad (53)$$

$$S_T^- = X_T - iY_T \quad (54)$$

and X, Y, Z are the Pauli matrices. Now we expand the ladder operators in terms of Pauli matrices only, and calling $T+1 = T'$.

$$e^{-i\theta} (X_T + iY_T) (X_{T'} - iY_{T'}) / 2 + e^{i\theta} (X_T - iY_T) (X_{T'} + iY_{T'}) / 2 \quad (55)$$

$$= e^{-i\theta} (X_T X_{T'} + Y_T Y_{T'} - iX_T Y_{T'} + iY_T X_{T'}) / 2 + e^{i\theta} (X_T X_{T'} + Y_T Y_{T'} + iX_T Y_{T'} - iY_T X_{T'}) / 2 \quad (56)$$

Re-grouping :

$$= \left(\frac{e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta}}{2} \right) (X_T X_{T'} + Y_T Y_{T'}) + \left(\frac{e^{i\theta} - e^{-i\theta}}{2} \right) (iX_T Y_{T'} - iY_T X_{T'}) \quad (57)$$

$$= \cos \theta (X_T X_{T'} + Y_T Y_{T'}) - \sin \theta (X_T Y_{T'} - Y_T X_{T'}). \quad (58)$$

So the twist then results in the local interaction:

$$H_l = J_T \cos \theta (X_T X_{T'} + Y_T Y_{T'}) - J_T \sin \theta (X_T Y_{T'} - Y_T X_{T'}) + Z_T Z_{T'} \quad (59)$$

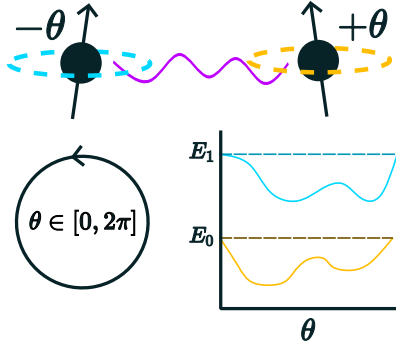


FIG. 6. Local twist

The Berry phase at a link (and other similar systems) can be calculated via numerical algorithms shown by Hatsugai's work⁶⁷, which involve diagonalizing twisted Hamiltonians and computing the integral for γ_n . The Berry phase ends up picking the dimer pattern as seen in Figure 7 taken from Hatsugai's paper.

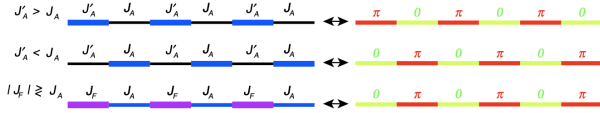


Figure 1. One-dimensional Heisenberg models with alternating exchange interactions with periodic boundary condition (left). Numerically evaluated quantized Berry phases (right). $J_A, J_B > 0$ and $J_B < 0$. The results are independent of the system size.

FIG. 7. Local characterization of the dimerized spin chain by numerical algorithm⁶.

We now turn to the question: how can we calculate the Berry phase using a quantum algorithm?

IV. QUANTUM ALGORITHM: DIMERIZED MODEL

A. Canceling the dynamical phase

As exposed in section II, when a quantum system is evolved adiabatically, the final state picks up two phases, the dynamical phase φ_D and the Berry phase φ_B . More specifically, in a closed loop, the initial state (prepared in the ground state) and final state are related⁹:

$$|\psi_0(T)\rangle = e^{-i\varphi_D} e^{i\varphi_B} |\psi_0(0)\rangle, \quad (60)$$

$$\varphi_D = \frac{1}{\hbar} \int_0^T E(q(t)) dt, \quad (61)$$

$$\varphi_B = i \oint_C \langle \psi_0(q) | \nabla_q | \psi_0(q) \rangle \cdot dq. \quad (62)$$

It is important to note that the Berry phase φ_B is independent of time, it only depends on the closed curved itself, not on how it is travelled on. On the other hand, the dynamical phase φ_D is time dependent. If we evolve the system backwards time, the dynamical phase changes sign:

$$\varphi'_D = \frac{1}{\hbar} \int_T^0 E(q(t)) dt \quad (63)$$

$$= \frac{1}{\hbar} \int_0^T E(q(t)) (-dt) = -\varphi_D$$

So consider first evolving forward in time, where the parameters form a closed loop, for a period T and then backwards in time for another closed loop period T :

$$|\psi_0\rangle \rightarrow e^{-i\varphi_D} e^{i\varphi_B} |\psi_0\rangle \rightarrow e^{2i\varphi_B} |\psi_0\rangle. \quad (64)$$

The forward propagation picks up both phases normally. Backwards propagation removes the dynamical phase, as the new contribution has a sign flip. Since the Berry phase does not depend on time, it is again picked up. We now need to remove the factor 2 from the Berry phase, since it renders the quantization of 0 and π meaningless, they become equal. Instead of fully evolving during a period T , we evolve it during a period $T/2$. Calling $U(t_0, t_f)$ a unitary operator which evolves a system adiabatically from an initial time t_0 to a final time t_f , the evolution of the state can be represented as:

$$U(T/2, 0) U(0, T/2) |\psi_0(0)\rangle = e^{i\varphi_B} |\psi_0(0)\rangle. \quad (65)$$

The evolution would follow the paths:

$$\begin{cases} t & 0 \rightarrow T/2 \rightarrow 0 \\ \theta & 0 \rightarrow \pi \rightarrow 2\pi \end{cases} \quad (66)$$

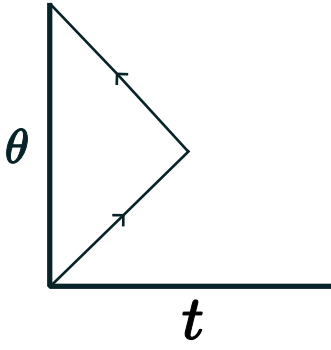


FIG. 8. Path evolution of parameters

The scheme for evolving for half-periods does not work generally, only if the energy spectrum is symmetric in the parameter space. Evolving for half a period forward and then backwards only applies when we have a symmetric energy spectrum along the parameter curve, which is the case for the local twist in the dimerized spin chain (whose energy spectrum does not vary with the twist, it remains constant). The concept can be visualized in the following figure.

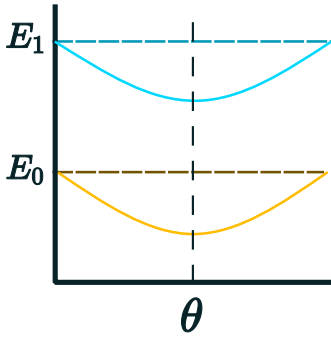


FIG. 9. Symmetric energy spectrum with respect to parameter.

B. Hadamard test

Supposing we have a quantum circuit that can prepare qubits in an initial ground state of the dimerized chain and then evolve it in time via a unitary operator, we can then measure the Berry phase. The idea is to do a simple Hadamard test, with the aid of an auxiliary qubit¹⁰. This is possible by initializing the auxiliary qubit in the $|+\rangle$ superposition state. Then by conditioning the unitary evolution of the spin-chain on the qubit, the Berry phase will be kicked into the auxiliary qubit as a relative phase:

$$|\psi_{\text{aux}}\rangle = \begin{cases} \text{Initial state} & |0\rangle \\ \text{Hadamard} & |+\rangle \\ \text{Controlled unitary} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle + e^{i\varphi_B}|1\rangle) \end{cases} \quad (67)$$

Due to the quantization of the berry phase $\varphi = \{0, \pi\}$, the state after the controlled unitary should be one of the two X-basis states (superposition states) $|+\rangle$ or $|-\rangle$. We then apply

another Hadamard gate, the auxiliary qubit can only be in two different states:

$$|\psi_{\text{aux}}\rangle = \begin{cases} |0\rangle & \varphi_B = 0 \\ |1\rangle & \varphi_B = \pi \end{cases} \quad (68)$$

which means that if 100% of measurements are 0, then the Berry phase is 0, and if 100% are 1, then the Berry phase is π . We can visualize the circuit in the following diagram:

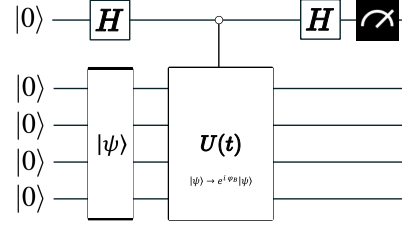


FIG. 10. Circuit visualizations

Of course the correct thing to do is to not assume quantization and explicitly calculate the phase. Thus, having prepared the algorithm, we can run it many times and collect statistics, from which we extract the Berry phase.

$$P(|0\rangle) = \cos^2 \theta_B / 2 \quad (69)$$

C. Time-stepping: Trotterization

The time-evolution of a time-dependent Hamiltonian is a time-ordered exponential of the form¹¹:

$$U(t_0, t_f) = T \left[\exp \left(-i \int_{t_0}^{t_f} H(t) dt \right) \right]. \quad (70)$$

We can split our Hamiltonian into even indices and odd indices, the usefulness will become apparent later.

$$H(t) = H_{\text{even}}(t) + H_{\text{odd}}(t) = A(t) + B(t). \quad (71)$$

When a Hamiltonian has the form $H(t) = A(t) + B(t)$, an infinitesimal evolution from a time t to $t + \Delta t$ can be approximated to second order by¹¹

$$G(t, t + \Delta t) = e^{-\frac{i}{2}\Delta t A(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} e^{-i\Delta t B(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} e^{-\frac{i}{2}\Delta t A(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})}. \quad (72)$$

The Hamiltonian we are considering only has time-dependence in the twisted link, which belongs either to the even subset of interactions or odd. We will define $B(t)$ as the subset with the twist. Thus $H(t) = A + B(t)$ and

$$G(t, t + \Delta t) = e^{-\frac{i}{2}\Delta t A} e^{-i\Delta t B(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} e^{-\frac{i}{2}\Delta t A}. \quad (73)$$

The even index interactions commute amongst themselves, and odd interactions commute amongst themselves, but in general even interactions do not commute with odd. In other words, pairs of interactions separated by one link commute, i.e

$$\left[\sigma_i^{(\alpha)} \sigma_j^{(\alpha+1)}, \sigma_k^{(\alpha+2)} \sigma_l^{(\alpha+3)} \right] = 0, \quad (74)$$

with upper indices referring to the spin "position" in the chain and σ_i being a Pauli matrix. It is also important to note that "normal" spin interactions (XX, YY, ZZ) on the same link commute, i.e

$$\begin{aligned} & \left[\sigma_i^{(\alpha)} \sigma_i^{(\beta)}, \sigma_j^{(\alpha)} \sigma_j^{(\beta)} \right] \\ &= \sigma_i \sigma_j^{(\alpha)} \sigma_i \sigma_j^{(\beta)} - \sigma_j \sigma_i^{(\alpha)} \sigma_j \sigma_i^{(\beta)}. \end{aligned} \quad (75)$$

Clearly if $i = j$, the commutator is 0. If they are not equal, using $[\sigma_i, \sigma_j] = i\epsilon_{ijk}\sigma_k$ we find that

$$\left[\sigma_i^{(\alpha)} \sigma_i^{(\beta)}, \sigma_j^{(\alpha)} \sigma_j^{(\beta)} \right] = -\sigma_k^{(\alpha)} \sigma_k^{(\beta)} + \sigma_k^{(\alpha)} \sigma_k^{(\beta)} = 0. \quad (76)$$

Thus each part of the evolution (even and odd) can be decomposed into its constituent interactions via the known multiplication of exponents:

$$e^{-i\Delta t H_{A/B}} = e^{-i\Delta t X_i X_{i+1}} e^{-i\Delta t Y_i Y_{i+1}} e^{-i\Delta t Z_i Z_{i+1}} e^{-i\Delta t X_{i+2} X_{i+3}} \dots \quad (77)$$

A problem arises when considering the twist in $B(t)$, it contains non-commutative terms within the link, specifically

$$\left[X^{(\alpha)} Y^{(\alpha+1)}, Y^{(\alpha)} X^{(\alpha+1)} \right] \neq 0, \quad (78)$$

We must again split this part of Hamiltonian with the twist into commuting parts and non-commuting parts, i.e

$$B\left(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2}\right) = B_1\left(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2}\right) + B_2\left(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2}\right), \quad (79)$$

for convenience giving B_2 the XY and YX interactions, which do not commute with the rest of B . We then approximate this using a Suzuki decomposition to second order¹¹:

$$e^{-i\Delta t B(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} \approx e^{-\frac{i\Delta t}{2} B_1(t + \Delta t/2)} e^{-i\Delta t B_2(t + \Delta t/2)} e^{-\frac{i\Delta t}{2} B_1(t + \Delta t/2)}. \quad (80)$$

We now arrive to an approximation of discrete time-evolution to second order:

$$\begin{aligned} G(t, t + \Delta t) &= e^{-i\Delta t A/2} e^{-\frac{i\Delta t}{2} B_1(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} e^{-i\Delta t B_2(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} \\ &\quad e^{-\frac{i\Delta t}{2} B_1(t + \frac{\Delta t}{2})} e^{-i\Delta t A/2}, \end{aligned} \quad (81)$$

where

$$A = J_a \sum_{i \in A} \mathbf{S}_i \cdot \mathbf{S}_{i+1}, \quad (82)$$

$$\begin{aligned} B_1(t) &= J_b \sum_{i \neq T \in B} \mathbf{S}_i \cdot \mathbf{S}_{i+1} \\ &\quad + J_b \cos(\theta(t)) (X_T X_{T+1} + Y_T Y_{T+1}) + J_b Z_T Z_{T+1}, \end{aligned} \quad (83)$$

$$B_2(t) = -J_b \sin(\theta(t)) (X_T Y_{T+1} - Y_T X_{T+1}). \quad (84)$$

The full time evolution is approximated as:

$$U(t_0, t_f) = \prod_{j=1}^N G(t_j, t_j + \Delta t) \quad (85)$$

$$= G((N-1)\Delta t, t_f) \dots G(t_0 + \Delta t, t_0 + 2\Delta t) G(t_0, t_0 + \Delta t).$$

D. Algorithm outline

We define an initial time t_0 and final time t_f . The twist will evolve in a loop, as time goes forward and then backwards. The period of the evolution is then $T = t_f - t_0$. We will evolve our system in small steps. So we discretize the evolution into N steps indexed by j :

$$\Delta t = T/N, \quad (86)$$

$$t_j = j\Delta t. \quad (87)$$

During the evolution, θ must be evolved to 2π , so then

$$\theta(t) = \frac{2\pi}{T} t \quad (88)$$

$$\theta_j = \frac{2\pi}{T} j\Delta t = \frac{2\pi j}{N} = j\Delta\theta. \quad (89)$$

Since the time propagation actually looks different, it is important to show

$$\theta(t_j + \Delta t/2) = \frac{2\pi}{T} (t_j + \Delta t) \quad (90)$$

$$= \frac{2\pi}{T} (j\Delta t + \Delta t/2)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
&= \frac{2\pi}{T} \left(j + \frac{1}{2}\right) \frac{T}{N} \\
&= \left(j + \frac{1}{2}\right) \Delta\theta.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus we propagate forward in time for $N/2$ steps, then we propagate backwards in time by flipping the sign of time ($-\Delta t$) for another $N/2$ steps, while twisting the link until it reaches 2π as in figure Figure 8.

E. Qiskit Gates

The exponentials of A and B_1 can easily be implemented in Qiskit.

$$e^{-iJ_a\Delta t A/2} = \prod_{i \in A} e^{-iJ_a\Delta t X_i X_{i+1}/2} e^{-iJ_a\Delta t Y_i Y_{i+1}/2} e^{-iJ_a\Delta t Z_i Z_{i+1}/2} \quad (91)$$

Qiskit has implementations for each of those unitary two qubit operators, RXXGate, RYYGate, RZZGate, respectively. These interactions can then be implemented in Qiskit:

$$e^{-iJ_a\Delta t A/2} = \prod_{i \in A} RXX_{i,i+1}(\varphi_a) RYY_{i,i+1}(\varphi_a) RZZ_{i,i+1}(\varphi_a), \quad (92)$$

with $\varphi_a = \Delta t J_a$. Similarly with the B_1 exponential, which has twist terms that commute:

$$\begin{aligned}
&e^{-iJ_b\Delta t B_1/2} \\
&= RXX_{T,T+1}(\varphi_b \cos \theta) RYY_{T,T+1}(\varphi_b \cos \theta) RZZ_{T,T+1}(\varphi_b) \\
&\quad \prod_{i \neq T \in B} RXX_{i,i+1}(\varphi_b) RYY_{i,i+1}(\varphi_b) RZZ_{i,i+1}(\varphi_b), \quad (93)
\end{aligned}$$

with $\varphi_b = \Delta t J_b$ and subindex T referring to the link with the twist. The interesting term is the exponent of B_2 . It can be implemented with the RXXPlusYY gate, by setting it's second parameter $\beta = -\pi/2$. Qiskit defines the RXXPlusYYGate as:

$$R_{\frac{XX+YY}{2}}(\theta, \beta) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \cos \theta/2 & -ie^{-i\beta} \sin \theta/2 & 0 \\ 0 & -ie^{i\beta} \sin \theta/2 & \cos \theta/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (94)$$

Setting $\beta = -\pi/2$, we call the resulting matrix an $RXY(\theta)$ gate:

$$R_{\frac{XX+YY}{2}}(\theta, -\pi/2) = RXY(\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \cos \theta/2 & \sin \theta/2 & 0 \\ 0 & -\sin \theta/2 & \cos \theta/2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (95)$$

Also, it can be shown (quite quickly in Mathematica) that

$$\exp[-i\varphi(X \otimes Y - Y \otimes X)] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \cos 2\varphi & \sin 2\varphi & 0 \\ 0 & -\sin 2\varphi & \cos 2\varphi & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (96)$$

Clearly

$$\exp[-i\varphi(X \otimes Y - Y \otimes X)] = RXY(4\varphi). \quad (97)$$

Thus the B_2 exponent is explicitly:

$$\begin{aligned}
e^{-iJ_b\Delta t B_2} &= e^{-iJ_b\Delta t (-\sin \theta (X_T Y_{T+1} - Y_T X_{T+1}))} \\
&= RXY_{T,T+1}(-4\varphi_b \sin \theta). \quad (98)
\end{aligned}$$

F. Results

The algorithm exposed in the previous section was implemented in Qiskit using Python. The code can be found on my Github. A parameter sweep was performed for different dimer strengths α , setting $J = 1$, with $T = 20$ and $N = 200$. Square errors were calculated for the Berry phase in a bond, and different system sizes were tested. Results are plotted in Figure 11.

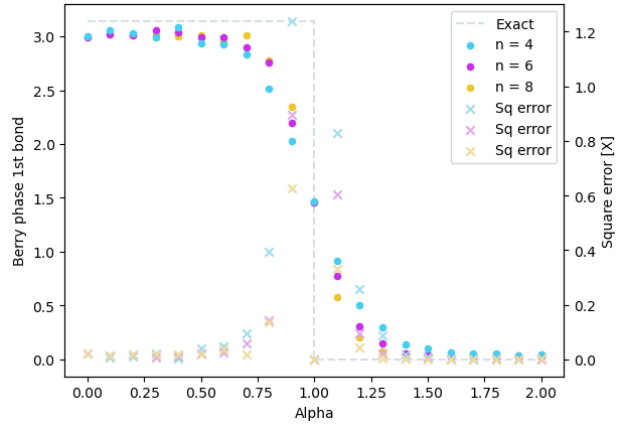


FIG. 11. Algorithm results running algorithm in Aer-Simulator with 100,000 shots.

A phase transition can be seen at a link, where the topological order changes from π to 0. We can see that the algorithm works relatively well. Errors increase when the alternating link strengths approach. Finite size effects are observable. Although it shows promise, the final gate depths varied between 70,000 gates and 140,000 gates. This algorithm is not runnable on hardware available to-day. To test this idea, a basic single qubit-error noise model was used as shown on Qiskit tutorials. To get sensible results, one would need a computer with less than 0.0001% errors. This can be seen in the following figure.

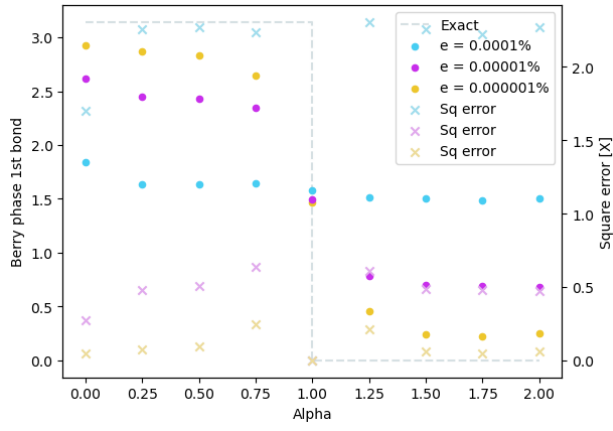


FIG. 12. Algorithm results for different noise levels, using 4 qubits.

The (uncontrolled) circuit can be visualized in the following figure.

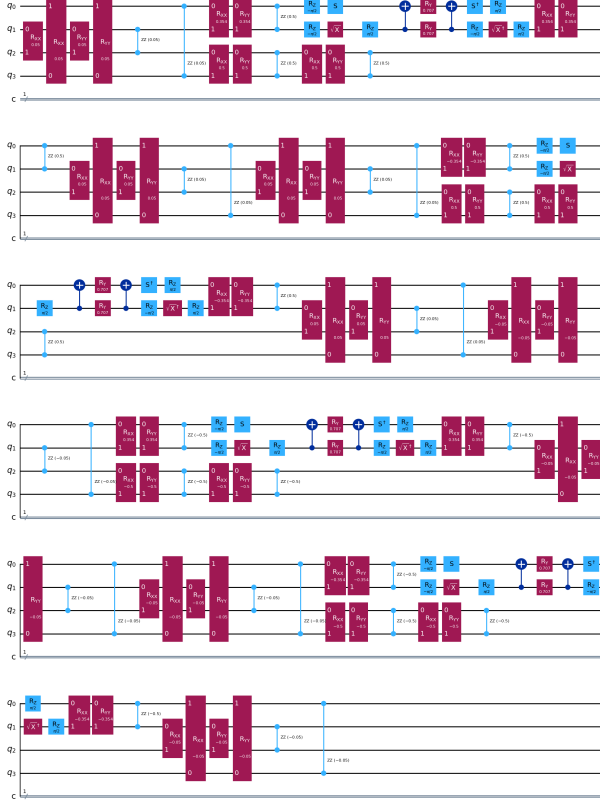


FIG. 13. Circuit diagram for 4 time steps.

G. Conclusion

This work shows a quantum algorithm which can distinguish different states in dimerized spin chains and can characterize phase transitions, highlighting the use of quantum computers to understand quantum matter. It is important to note

that although the algorithm works pretty well, there are too many gates in the circuit, so it is not realizable in real quantum computers available today.

V. 2D DIMERIZED MODEL

In this case, we now consider the 2D model with the same alternating pattern of interaction strengths in the "x" and "y" directions of the lattice. The Hamiltonian has the form:

$$H = \sum_{\langle i,j \rangle} J_{ij} \mathbf{S}_i \cdot \mathbf{S}_j, \quad (99)$$

$$J_{ij} = J \delta_x \delta_y + \alpha \delta_{x+1} \delta_{y+1},$$

$$\delta_k = \begin{cases} 0 & k = 0 \pmod{2} \\ 1 & k = 1 \pmod{2} \end{cases}.$$

This 2D dimerized pattern forms three types of plaquettes. The first type *I* is when all of the links have their interaction strengths equal to the stronger coefficient J . The second type *II* is when their interaction strengths are the weaker coefficient α . The third type *III* is a mixture of interaction strengths. It can be visualized in the following figure.

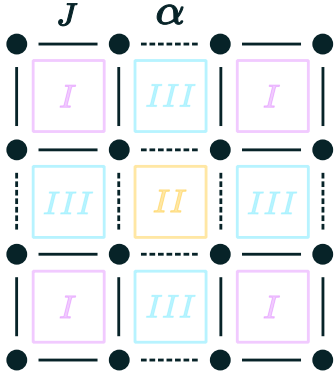


FIG. 14. 2D dimerized lattice. Plaquettes of different types (shown with labels and colors) can be distinguished as closed links with different mixtures of interaction strengths.

According to Hatsugai et al¹²⁶, this system should still have some quantization of $\varphi_B = \{0, \pi\}$ (it still maintains anti-unitary symmetry), and they show that it is computable via "classical" numerics. Upon analysis of his work, some inconsistencies were found in the decoupled limit (degeneracies are introduced), mostly related to the way the parameter evolution was taken. So let us start from the ground up.

The idea is to find a local topological invariant also for this 2D system. One can then think to add a local twist on every link within a plaquette.

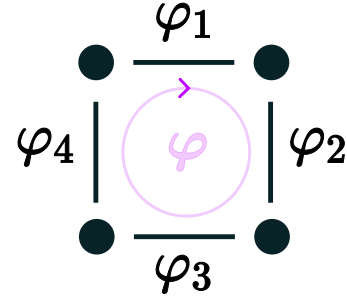


FIG. 15. Plaquette twist on each link.

In the case of only one plaquette, i.e 4 spins interacting with each other. We define the twists on each site with a 4-vector $\varphi = (\varphi_1, \varphi_2, \varphi_3, \varphi_4)$. We can find the eigenvalues for this system (Mathematica does this nicely). Whenever the sum of the 4-vector is less than π , the ground state energy corresponds to:

$$E_0 = -2J \left(1 + \sqrt{5 + 2\sqrt{2 + 2\cos|\varphi|}} \right), \quad (100)$$

$$|\varphi| = \varphi_1 + \varphi_2 + \varphi_3 + \varphi_4 \quad (101)$$

This suggests we can find an evolution of parameters, whose magnitude always stays below this threshold, following a closed loop. This would guarantee that whatever the wavefunction is, it will stay the ground state. The easiest way to evolve the Hamiltonian is then to take pairs of parameters, evolve them in time and make them anti-symmetric i.e:

$$\varphi_\mu(t) = -\varphi_\gamma(t), \mu \neq \gamma \quad (102)$$

The parameter space can be thought of as a 4-torus with a "Lorentzian" metric. We can avoid degeneracies by moving in paths which avoid the metric going to π . The following figure illustrates the idea.

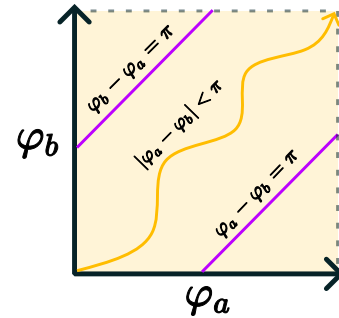


FIG. 16. Parameter space of single plaquette. Purple lines indicate diagonals where the energy becomes degenerate. Any path (yellow) that avoids these diagonals maps Eigenstates uniquely.

The following table shows the Berry phase calculation (via a Wilson loop) when taking pairs.

Twist A	Twist B	Berry	Commute
φ_1	φ_2	Π	No
φ_1	φ_4	Π	No
φ_2	φ_3	Π	No
φ_3	φ_4	Π	No
φ_2	φ_4	0	Yes
φ_1	φ_3	0	Yes

It is interesting to see that commuting twists (when anti-aligned) gives rise to no Berry phase, which suggests that these two leave the ground wavefunction invariant (or you can stipulate that you somehow double-loop around the parameter space).

A. Unitary evolution & Hamiltonian decomposition

In order to get a good approximation, infinitesimal evolution operator of the system, we group the full 2D model into 4 groups of commuting twists as shown in the following figure.

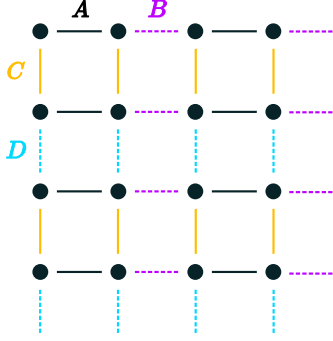


FIG. 17. Grouping of interactions, which commute within the group.

A relevant twist of plaquettes I and II will only include two groups, either A and C, or B and D. We now choose to decompose the Hamiltonian with the twist assumed on A and C. We thus decompose to second order by grouping A+C and B+D, since A and C have all the time dependence. After this, another second order decomposition is required to split B and D. A and C will have to also be split to second order, considering the time-dependence. Then A and C will have the same implementation as before, where the twists are then also decomposed to second order

$$G(t, t + \Delta t) \approx G_{BD} G_A G_C G_A G_{BD}, \quad (103)$$

$$G_{BD} = e^{-i\alpha\Delta t B/4} e^{-i\alpha\Delta t D/2} e^{-i\alpha\Delta t B/4}$$

$$G_A(t, t + \Delta t) = e^{-iJ\frac{\Delta t}{4}A_T(t+\Delta t/2)} e^{-iJ\frac{\Delta t}{2}A(t+\Delta t/2)} e^{-iJ\frac{\Delta t}{4}A_T(t+\Delta t/2)}$$

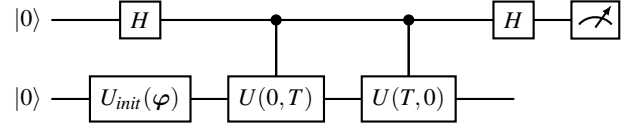


FIG. 19. Algorithm outline

$$G_C(t, t + \Delta t) = e^{-iJ\frac{\Delta t}{2}C_T(t+\Delta t/2)} e^{-iJ\Delta t C(t+\Delta t/2)} e^{-iJ\frac{\Delta t}{2}C_T(t+\Delta t/2)},$$

where subindex T means that it is the operator with the twisted interaction of the group.

B. Results & conclusion

All of the previous operations can be decomposed into two qubit operations as shown in the previous sections. The time-evolution algorithm can also be implemented directly. When implementing this decomposition numerically and doing the evolution, it was needed to take around 100 discretization steps in order to get a good approximation. This can be coded in a similar fashion into Qiskit. In Qiskit, only 20 steps leads to 60,000 gates. 100 steps resulted in 385,000 gates. Additionally, ground state preparation takes forever to complete, hinting that one would need to find some creative way to set it up (i.e a very well thought out VQE).

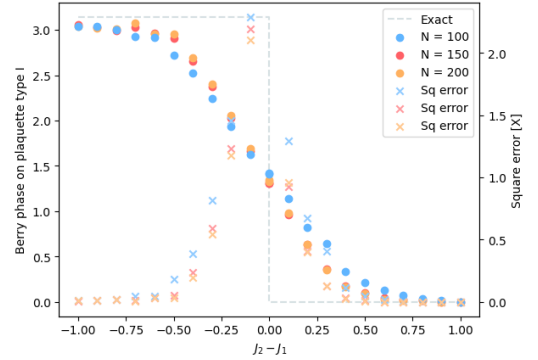


FIG. 18. Berry phase for 4x4 system, computed in-silico, via Hamiltonian decomposition, and loop unitary evolution.

In conclusion, the quantum algorithm outline works. The steps are very clearly defined: decompose the evolution into commuting parts, until you reach two qubit operations (4x4 matrices), choose a parameter path and evolve in time (forwards and backwards), perform a Hadamard test or any other means to retrieve the phase (an interference experiment, numerically, etc.). In a future where fault-tolerant qubits exist, these algorithms should work well right out-of-the box.

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